

SAWAYATRA

SECTION 01 OF FOUR



THE ANDEAN CARAVAN • DAYS 1-23

01

Sea to Stone

Pacific coast, desert, deep canyon and the Stone Road

LIMA TO PUNO • 23 DAYS • MAXIMUM 12 TRAVELLERS

AUGUST 2026

A proposal you can picture yourself inside

A caravan is not a race down a route. It is a moving circle — travellers, hosts, vehicles and local knowledge — progressing slowly enough for each place to change the terms.

Section 01 is the first of four sections that tile one continuous 71-day passage from Lima to the end of the Carretera Austral. It begins at the Lima gate and closes at the Puno gate, where travellers may leave the Caravan or continue south into Section 02.

01 23 DAYS	02 16 DAYS	03 18 DAYS	04 14 DAYS	
LIMA	PUNO	SUCRE	SANTIAGO	BALMACEDA

YOUR GATES

Join at Lima, leave at Puno. Days 16–23 may also be booked on their own as The Stone Road, joining the existing Caravan at Cusco.

IMPORTANT

This is a route proposal, not yet a confirmed departure.

It communicates the intended route, pace and level of effort. Exact dates, named properties, suppliers, tickets, departure times, prices and meal inclusions become final only after the 2028 operating plan is secured. Weather, permits, border authorities and vessel operators can change the order or content of a day; this guide names those dependencies wherever they affect your choice.

Effort is more than walking distance

Every day separates physical effort from the operating environment. A short day can still be demanding if it sleeps high, begins early, changes hotels or removes access to easy recovery.

PHYSICAL EFFORT

■ LIGHT

Arrival, recovery, buffer or compact programme. The point is to create room around the harder days.

■ STEADY

A normal travelling day: walking, road movement, a visit or a hotel change without concentrated load.

■ DEMANDING

Long movement, significant altitude, rough ground, early start, complex boarding or several load signals together.

OPERATING ENVIRONMENT

CONNECTED

Reliable services and straightforward access to support.

LIMITED SERVICES

Fewer choices and slower access to support; planning matters.

REMOTE

Simple infrastructure, long transfer routes and limited communications or facilities.

FREE TIME

When the guide says free time, it means genuinely uncommitted time. It is not a space waiting to be filled later by a compulsory tour.

Sea to Stone

From sea level, the Caravan moves slowly south through Peru's coastal desert, climbs to Arequipa and Colca, then reaches Cusco, the Sacred Valley and two separately ticketed visits to Machu Picchu before crossing the altiplano to Puno.

HIGHEST POINT

4,910 m at Patapampa

MOVEMENT

Road, passenger boat, rail and one scheduled flight

SLEEP AT CLOSE

Approx. 3,800 m at Puno

SEASON

February — coastal summer and Andean wet season

THE STAGES

Desert Coast

Days 1–8

White City, Deep Canyon

Days 9–15

The Stone Road — also available as the short form

Days 16–23

THE STONE ROAD · 8 DAYS

Days 16–23 may be booked as the short form from Cusco to Puno. Join by the previous evening; Day 16 is protected. The Stone Road joins the existing group and shares the same 12-place capacity.

01 Arrive in Lima

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Lima	Lima	Protected airport transfer	■ Light · Connected

A Host or named representative meets each arrival and brings the traveller to the first hotel. There is no group visit, welcome performance or concealed first-day schedule. The job of the day is to arrive.

FREE TIME *The day remains uncommitted after check-in. A simple arrival meal may be offered once meal inclusions are set.*

02 Objects before chronology

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Lima	Lima	City vehicle and short walks	■ Light · Connected

A guided morning at Museo Larco begins with material culture rather than a compressed history lecture. Lunch is unhurried. The afternoon is kept open for rest, a garden or an optional neighbourhood walk.

FREE TIME *From mid-afternoon. A real free period, not an optional paid excursion inserted later.*

03 Market, kitchens and Barranco

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Lima	Lima	Several short city transfers	■ Steady · Connected

The food day begins at Surquillo market, then follows a small number of ingredients through makers, kitchens or tables. Barranco belongs later in the day, when the light and the pace have both softened.

FREE TIME *A quiet break is built between the food programme and Barranco. The evening is free.*

04 Pachacámac and south to Paracas

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Lima to Pachacámac to Paracas	Paracas	Approx. 4.5 to 5.5 hours road plus site	■ Demanding · Limited services

The Caravan leaves Lima early on the Panamericana Sur and stops at Pachacámac within the first hour, where the site sits on the road rather than at the end of a return excursion. The site is exposed, uneven and larger than the group needs to cover on foot; vehicle-supported interpretation keeps the visit complete without treating distance as achievement. The road then continues to Paracas, and the evening is left alone.

FREE TIME *After arrival and check-in. No sunset activity is fixed to a traffic-sensitive day.*

05 Ballestas and the red coast

ROUTE

Paracas

SLEEP

Paracas

MOVEMENT

Boat block and reserve road

RHYTHM

■ Steady · Limited services

An early passenger boat goes towards the Ballestas Islands only when the harbour authority clears departures. The reserve follows by road, with the red coast and desert doing the work that the boat cannot be asked to guarantee.

FREE TIME *Late afternoon and evening at the same base.*

WEATHER

If boats are suspended, the reserve becomes the primary landscape day and receives more time. Departure depends on harbour clearance and sea state.

06 Tambo Colorado, Huacachina and the road to Nazca

ROUTE

Paracas to Tambo Colorado to Huacachina to Nazca

SLEEP

Nazca

MOVEMENT

Approx. 5 hours road across the day

RHYTHM

■ Steady · Limited services

The day turns inland for a contained visit to Tambo Colorado, then returns to the valley road. The route pauses at Huacachina without turning the oasis into a compulsory dune-buggy day. After a quiet lunch the Caravan continues to Nazca.

FREE TIME *A contained pause at Huacachina and a free evening in Nazca.*

07 The lines from the ground, Chauchilla and Sacaco

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Nazca to Chauchilla to Sacaco to Chala	Chala	Approx. 4 to 5 hours road plus sites	■ Steady · Limited services

The morning reads the Nazca lines from the mirador and the interpretive record — how they were made, who made them, what the desert surface does and does not preserve. Chauchilla follows, with its exposed cemetery landscape. After lunch the road turns south through Sacaco and its fossil marine beds to Chala on the coast.

FREE TIME *A quiet evening in Chala after a multi-stop day.*

08 The climb to Arequipa

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Chala to Arequipa	Arequipa	Approx. 7 to 8 hours road	■ Demanding · Limited services

One steady road day completes the coast. Meal and comfort stops are part of the plan. The road climbs from the Pacific to 2,335 m, and Arequipa is an arrival rather than one more visit.

FREE TIME *Only after check-in. The evening has no scheduled group content.*

09

Arequipa, first acclimatisation day

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Arequipa	Arequipa	Short local movement	Light · Connected

A brief Host-led orientation is the only fixed content. The city is read from a compact route, with the afternoon returned to the traveller.

FREE TIME *Most of the afternoon and evening.*

10

Arequipa, second acclimatisation day

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Arequipa	Arequipa	Half-day city visit	Light · Connected

One cultural visit occupies the morning. The remainder stays deliberately unprogrammed before the following day's high pass. Distance on foot is adjusted through vehicle support and a shorter interior route.

FREE TIME *From lunch onwards.*

11 Across Patapampa into Colca

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Arequipa to Patapampa to Colca	Yanque or Chivay	Approx. 4.5 to 5.5 hours road	Demanding · Limited services

The road crosses the high plateau and pauses only briefly at Patapampa. There is no walk staged at 4,910 m. The vehicle then descends to the chosen valley base, where the evening remains quiet.

FREE TIME After check-in. No added village circuit is attached to the arrival day.

ALTITUDE	A written symptom, oxygen, descent and medical-transfer protocol is required before this day is offered.
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12 Terraces and valley communities

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Colca Valley	Same Colca base	Short road links and uneven walks	Steady · Limited services

A contained morning follows selected terraces and communities rather than collecting every viewpoint. Local participation will be agreed and credited. The group returns to the same hotel before lunch or in the early afternoon.

FREE TIME A substantial afternoon at the same base.

13 Condor country, without a promise

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Colca Valley and Cruz del Cóndor	Same Colca base	Early road outing	■ Steady · Limited services

The group leaves early for Cruz del Cóndor, then returns through a small number of valley stops. Condors may use the morning thermals. Their appearance is not an inclusion. Cold, standing and rain are disclosed as part of the visit.

FREE TIME *The afternoon remains open at the same property.*

14 Return to Arequipa

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Colca to Arequipa	Arequipa	Approx. 4 to 5 hours road	■ Steady · Limited services

The Caravan returns to Arequipa without adding a second major visit. The afternoon and evening absorb road conditions, laundry and the practical work of the following flight.

FREE TIME *After arrival.*

LAUNDRY	A laundry opportunity is planned here, subject to final confirmation.
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15 Fly to Cusco

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Arequipa to Cusco	Cusco	Scheduled flight; approx. 4 to 5 hours door to door	Light · Connected

A direct scheduled flight is used if the secured 2028 timetable supports it. Nothing is programmed after arrival.

FREE TIME *After check-in.*

16 Cusco, arrival pace

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Cusco	Cusco	Short orientation	Light · Connected

A compact orientation, and the rest of the day open. No arrival activity is required at 3,400 m.

FREE TIME *Most of the day.*

17

Cusco at a slower pace

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Cusco	Cusco	City vehicle and adapted walk	Light · Connected

One compact morning visit gives the city room without stacking a monument circuit. Cobbles and steps are shortened by vehicle placement. Lunch is followed by an uncommitted afternoon.

FREE TIME *From early afternoon.*

18

Pisac and the Sacred Valley

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Cusco to Pisac to Urubamba	Urubamba area	Approx. 2 to 3 hours road across the day	Steady · Limited services

The group uses the upper vehicle access for a shortened archaeological route at Pisac, then descends into the Sacred Valley. The day ends near Urubamba rather than returning uphill to Cusco.

FREE TIME *Late afternoon at the valley base.*

19 Maras, Moray and Ollantaytambo

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Urubamba to Maras and Moray to Ollantaytambo	Ollantaytambo	Approx. 2 to 3 hours road	■ Steady · Limited services

Moray is visited in the morning, followed by Ollantaytambo town and an adapted archaeological route. The upper temple climb remains optional. Lower precincts and the town are treated as a complete visit, not a consolation.

FREE TIME *A quiet evening in Ollantaytambo before the train movement.*

20 First Machu Picchu entry

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Ollantaytambo to Machu Picchu Pueblo	Machu Picchu Pueblo	Rail, bus and timed walking circuit	■ Demanding · Limited services

A morning train reaches Machu Picchu Pueblo. After the overnight bag is left at the hotel, the group takes the bus to a separately ticketed afternoon entry, planned around a panoramic route under the rules then in force.

FREE TIME *A short pause between hotel arrival and the timed entry. The evening is free after return to town.*

PERMITS	Do not name a circuit, entry time or viewpoint as guaranteed until the 2028 permits are issued and purchased.
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21 Second entry and return to Cusco

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Machu Picchu Pueblo to Cusco	Cusco	Bus, walking circuit, rail and road	Demanding · Limited services

A second, separately ticketed morning entry is planned around a complementary lower route. After lunch the group returns by rail and road to Cusco. This is the stage's highest walking effort and one of its longer movement days.

FREE TIME *Only after arrival in Cusco.*

22 Cusco weather buffer

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Cusco	Cusco	None unless recovery is required	Light · Connected

The entire day is held open. If rail or permit movement has slipped, it protects the stage. If the route has run to schedule, the day belongs to rest, laundry and individual time. It is not back-filled with a compulsory tour.

FREE TIME *The whole day when the buffer is not needed.*

23 Across the altiplano by day train, and the Puno gate

ROUTE	SLEEP	MOVEMENT	RHYTHM
Cusco to Puno	Puno	Current service approx. 10 hours 30 minutes	Demanding · Limited services

The PeruRail Titicaca day train crosses the altiplano and La Raya before arriving in Puno in the early evening. Dining, live music and traditional dance are part of the present service model. The day is low in walking and long in sitting. For travellers ending here, this is the last day of the Caravan. For travellers continuing, the Puno night is the gate: the close of Section 01 and the protected beginning of Section 02.

FREE TIME *None is promised beyond the train journey and arrival evening.*

TIMING	As checked on 8 August 2026, services from Cusco operated on Wednesdays, Fridays and Sundays from January to April. Day 23 must land on a secured 2028 operating day, and Day 1 falls one weekday earlier.
AT THE GATE	Travellers joining Section 02 at Puno have completed the arranged Cusco progression and are already in Puno. The Section 01 group meets them on the evening of Day 23 or the morning of Day 24.

Where this section asks more of you

Day 4 and Day 8 are long road days; Days 6 and 7 are multi-stop days with hotel changes.

Pachacámac, Tambo Colorado, Chauchilla and Sacaco are exposed to heat and sun, with uneven or unsealed ground.

Patapampa at 4,910 m is the second-highest point on the whole Caravan and is reached on Day 11.

Cruz del Cóndor involves an early start, cold, standing and uneven viewing areas.

Pisac, Ollantaytambo and both Machu Picchu entries use stone, steps and wet-season surfaces. Machu Picchu requires timed, one-way circuits; a person cannot leave and re-enter on the same ticket.

Day 23 is more than ten hours on the train and crosses approximately 4,335 m at La Raya.

The section ends at 3,800 m. A traveller leaving at Puno should plan their onward travel with that in mind.

FOR SHORT-FORM TRAVELLERS

The eight days begin at 3,400 m and end at 3,800 m, with a descent into the Sacred Valley in between. The demanding days are 20, 21 and 23. Individual medical advice about altitude is required in the same terms as for the full section.

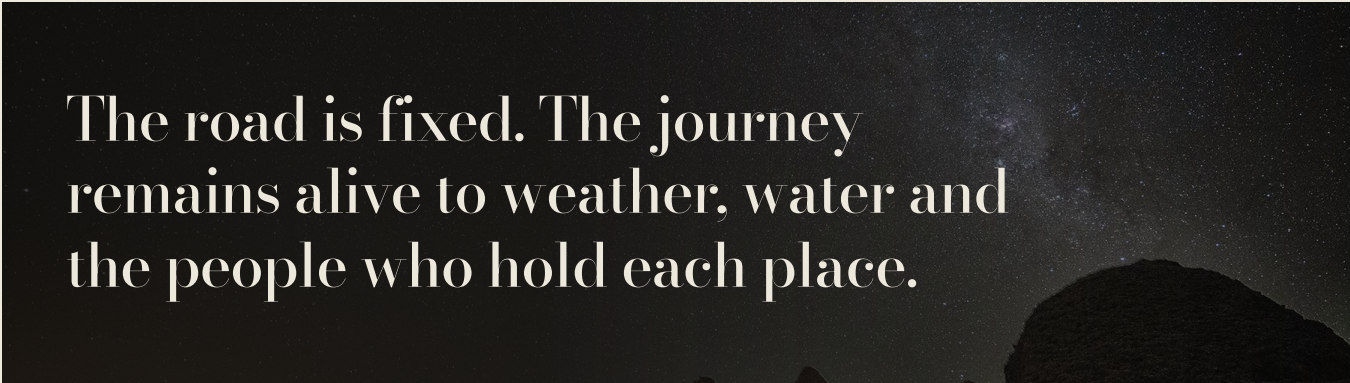
SLEEP PATTERN

Lima three nights, Paracas two, Nazca one, Chala one, Arequipa three across two stops, one Colca base for three nights, Cusco four nights across two stops, one night near Urubamba, one at Ollantaytambo, one at Machu Picchu Pueblo, and the Puno gate night. Chala and Machu Picchu Pueblo are the two properties requiring the closest inspection.

From route proposal to your departure

This guide is the clearest picture of the intended journey through Sea to Stone. Before this section is offered as a secured departure, Sawayatra will reconcile the calendar, contract the route-critical trains, flights, ferries, refuges and local encounters, inspect access and accommodation, and publish the exact inclusion and cancellation terms.

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| 01 | Choose the passage | One section, consecutive sections, The Stone Road, or the full 71 days. |
| 02 | Discuss readiness | Altitude, walking, access, room basis, luggage and the demands that matter to you. |
| 03 | Receive the secured detail | Dates, price, properties, flights, inclusions, medical and insurance requirements, and the final day plan. |
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The road is fixed. The journey remains alive to weather, water and the people who hold each place.